

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUS, IT'S ALL HERE...

**THIS MONTH IN TECH:**  
Learn how to make your own personalised WhatsApp sticker pack and app. Additionally, we also reveal a guide to identifying those pesky fake video making rounds on the internet and more. Read on for much more in the world of tech before this eventful year comes to a close...



## Crypto massively loses value

Cryptocurrencies lost about \$6 Billion over the thanksgiving weekend bringing the total loss in the crypto market to approximately \$700 billion since January 2018. Bitcoin, in particular, dropped to about \$4,100 per pop. Ethereum also had major losses.

<https://dgit.in/CryptoNoNo>

### WHAT'S NEW

## IBM to acquire Red Hat for \$34Billion

**I**BM is acquiring Red Hat in a deal that's currently valued at \$34 Billion. IBM CEO Ginni Rometty and Red Hat CEO Jim Whitehurst, in a joint statement, announced that the open-source software and technology company that is known for maintaining open-source projects such as GNOME, MRG, OpenShift, OpenStack, LibreOffice, etc. will become a part of IBM's Hybrid Cloud division. Red Hat began 25 years ago with a focus on distributing the Linux and Unix software accessories. They eventually became known for Red Hat Enterprise Linux. Should this acquisition go through, it will be IBM's largest ever and the third-largest in the history of US tech companies. IBM has several software offerings and they've



been betting big on BlueMix, Watson, SoftLayer, etc. so the Red Hat acquisition adds a lot of additional software to IBM's portfolio and they're all open-source. Analysts worldwide have agreed that this deal makes IBM more relevant in the cloud market.

<https://dgit.in/IBMRH>

## US rallies allies to boycott Huawei

**T**he US Government has begun speaking to allies to prevent Huawei from obtaining key infrastructure contracts. The reason for this extreme move is the fact that Huawei has close ties to the Chinese Government. Huawei is the world's No.2 smartphone manufacturer and is rapidly gaining market share. According to Wall Street Journal, the US Government has approached Germany, Italy and Japan about Huawei.



The current US administration is considering offering financial aid for countries to remove Huawei. One of the prime reasons for this move is Article 7 of China's 2017 National Intelligence Law which states, "All organisations

and citizens shall, in accordance with the law, support, cooperate with, and collaborate in national intelligence work, and guard the secrecy of national intelligence work they are aware of..." "The state will protect individuals and organisations that support, cooperate with, and collaborate in national intelligence work." It seems Chinese companies have little say in the matter and are forced to cooperate.

<https://dgit.in/HuaweiUSno>



logitech

### Logitech offers 2.2 Billion to acquire Plantronics

Logitech intends to acquire peripherals manufacturer Plantronics just months after it announced the acquisition of Blue Microphones. Reuters reports that Logitech has offered Plantronics \$2.2 Billion in late November.

<https://dgit.in/LogiPlan>



### Apple's T2 chip blocks third-party repairs

The T2 coprocessor requires Apple's diagnostic software be run while being connected to the Internet. Only then does the T2 chip get the green signal to allow the MacBook to boot properly, otherwise it might be potentially bricked.

<https://dgit.in/AppleT2>



### Amazon exposed customer names and email IDs

Some Amazon customers have received an email informing them that their names and email IDs have been exposed because of a technical error. Amazon said that the issue was resolved but didn't provide numbers of affected people.

<https://dgit.in/AmaDohn>